1099 MONEY · FREE PRINTABLE

The 2027 Freelancer Tax Calendar

Every federal date a US freelancer needs next year, what to do on each one, and a 10-minute monthly routine so April is boring.

- Every deadline, dated
- Quarterly payment checklist
- Set-aside table
- Printable wall page



Edition 2027.1 · 2026 and 2027 federal dates

Educational content. Not tax advice.

YEAR AT A GLANCE

Every date that matters

Federal dates for a sole proprietor filing Schedule C. A date on a weekend or federal holiday moves to the next business day (already applied below). Your state has its own dates: add them in the blank rows.

Date	What's due	Covers
Fri Jan 15, 2027	4th estimated payment for your 2026 income. *Skip it only if you file your 2026 return and pay in full by Feb 1.*	Sep–Dec 2026
Fri Jan 15, 2027	Last day of marketplace open enrollment (healthcare.gov) for 2027 coverage.	Health
Mon Feb 1, 2027	1099-NEC / 1099-K forms due *to you*. Also the day *your* 1099-NECs are due to any contractor you paid $2,000+ directly.	2026
Thu Apr 15, 2027	File your 2026 return (or an extension) and pay any balance. Last day for 2026 IRA contributions. **Plus** the 1st estimated payment for 2027.	2026 + Jan–Mar 2027
Tue Jun 15, 2027	2nd estimated payment for 2027. Only two months after April.	Apr–May
Wed Sep 15, 2027	3rd estimated payment for 2027.	Jun–Aug
Fri Oct 15, 2027	Extended 2026 return due (if you filed an extension). Last day to fund a 2026 SEP IRA on extension.	2026
Mon Nov 1, 2027	Marketplace open enrollment starts for 2028 coverage (pick by Dec 15 for a Jan 1 start).	Health
Fri Dec 31, 2027	Year-end: equipment you need placed in service, Solo 401(k) setup questions answered, logs caught up.	2027
Jan 18, 2028*	4th estimated payment for 2027.	Sep–Dec 2027
	My state:	
	My state:	
	My state:	

*Jan 15, 2028 is a Saturday and Jan 17 is a federal holiday, so the payment should be due Tue Jan 18, 2028. Confirm on irs.gov when the 2027 Form 1040-ES is published. Dates checked against IRS rules as of November 2026.

TIP

Put every bold date in your phone calendar now, with a reminder **one week before**. That week is when you do the 15-minute routine on the next page.

BEFORE EACH PAYMENT

The 15-minute payment routine

Do this one week before each estimated-tax date.

1. **Catch up your records.** Every client payment since last time in your income log; every business cost in your expense log; every business drive in your mileage log.
2. **Pick your number.** Either the *safe harbor* (a quarter of last year's total tax, or 110% of it if last year's AGI was over $150,000) or the *current-year* amount (90% of this year's projected tax, spread out). Paying the lesser on time generally avoids the underpayment penalty.
3. **Pay.** irs.gov/payments → Direct Pay (free) or your IRS Online Account → Estimated tax → 1040-ES → **the right tax year**. January's payment is for the year before.
4. **Save the confirmation.** Screenshot or email it to yourself, and log the amount.
5. **Pay your state** if it has an income tax: separate website, often the same dates.
6. **Check your tax savings.** Does it cover the rest of the year plus any April balance? If not, raise your set-aside percentage.

Payment log

Payment	Due	Amount paid	Date paid	Confirmation #
Q4 2026	Jan 15, 2027			
Q1 2027	Apr 15, 2027			
Q2 2027	Jun 15, 2027			
Q3 2027	Sep 15, 2027			
Q4 2027	Jan 18, 2028*			

WANT THE MATH DONE FOR YOU?

The free calculator on our site works out the payment from your profit. The **Quarterly Tax Tracker** ($15 spreadsheet + guide) does it from your own income and expense logs, all year.

EVERY MONTH

The 10-minute monthly check

- [ ] Label anything unclear on last month's business bank statement.
- [ ] Add missing income, expenses and mileage to your logs.
- [ ] Move any set-aside you forgot into the tax savings account.
- [ ] Send or chase invoices: anything overdue gets a reminder today.
- [ ] Pay yourself the usual amount from business to personal.

How much to set aside from every payment

Federal tax for a single filer with no other income, 2026 figures (self-employment tax + income tax, standard deduction, QBI deduction). Add your state on top.

Net profit for the year	Federal tax (approx.)	Share of profit	Set aside (with ~5% state)
$20,000	$3,025	15%	20%
$40,000	$7,427	19%	24%
$60,000	$12,037	20%	25%
$80,000	$16,647	21%	26%
$120,000	$28,462	24%	29%

Married filing jointly with no other household income usually owes less; a W-2 job on top usually means more. Round up for a cushion. Re-check each January when the tax tables change.

Three accounts

1 · INCOME

Business checking. Clients pay here.

2 · TAX

Separate savings. Your % moves here the same day.

3 · PAY

Personal account. A fixed "paycheck" every two weeks.

PRINT ME

2027 on one page

JAN

15 · Q4 2026 payment

15 · Open enrollment ends

FEB

1 · 1099s in (and out)

Close the 2026 books

MAR

File 2026 early

Decide SEP / IRA amount

APR

15 · File + pay 2026

15 · Q1 2027 payment

15 · 2026 IRA deadline

MAY

Monthly check

JUN

15 · Q2 payment

JUL

Mid-year: is your % right?

AUG

Monthly check

SEP

15 · Q3 payment

OCT

15 · Extended return due

NOV

1 · Open enrollment starts

Year-end plan

DEC

15 · Pick health plan

31 · Year-end moves

Every month: the 10-minute check. **Every payment:** the 15-minute routine. **Jan 18, 2028:** Q4 2027 payment.

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